GROW FOOD SYSTEM

ACTION KIT

Seasonal Growing Calendar

Know what to focus on, prepare, and review through the growing year. A seasonal reference guide for sowing, planting, and harvesting — designed for temperate climates.

- Seasonal sowing and planting guide
- Key tasks for each season
- Year-at-a-glance crop timeline
- Companion planting quick reference

This calendar is a general guide for temperate climates. Adjust sowing and planting dates based on your local frost dates and conditions.

Spring

March · April · May

MARCH

Sow indoors: Tomatoes, peppers, aubergines, lettuce, basil
Sow outdoors: Broad beans, peas, parsnips, spinach (if soil is workable)
Plant out: Onion sets, shallots, garlic (if not done in autumn)
Key tasks: Prepare beds, add compost, clean pots, plan layout

APRIL

Sow indoors: Courgettes, squash, cucumbers, sweetcorn
Sow outdoors: Beetroot, carrots, radishes, salad leaves, chard
Plant out: Potatoes (early varieties), strawberry runners
Key tasks: Harden off indoor seedlings, set up supports for climbing plants

MAY

Sow outdoors: French beans, runner beans, more salad, herbs
Plant out: Tomatoes, courgettes, squash (after last frost)
Harvest: Radishes, early salad leaves, spring onions, rhubarb
Key tasks: Succession sow salad every 2 weeks, mulch beds, start liquid feeding containers

SPRING PRIORITY

Do not rush. Wait until after your last frost date before planting tender crops outdoors (tomatoes, courgettes, beans). Starting too early is the most common spring mistake.

Summer

June · July · August

JUNE

Sow outdoors: More beans, beetroot, carrots, salad, herbs, courgettes (succession)
Plant out: Late-started brassicas, leeks
Harvest: Peas, broad beans, lettuce, radishes, strawberries, herbs
Key tasks: Water consistently, tie in tomatoes, remove side shoots, watch for pests

JULY

Sow outdoors: Spring cabbage (for autumn), more salad, turnips
Harvest: Courgettes, beans, tomatoes (late July), potatoes (earlies), onions, garlic
Key tasks: Feed tomatoes weekly, harvest courgettes small, water deeply in dry spells

AUGUST

Sow outdoors: Autumn salad, spinach, spring onions, overwintering onions
Harvest: Tomatoes, courgettes, beans, sweetcorn, peppers, cucumbers, berries
Key tasks: Preserve surplus (freeze, dry, or can), collect seeds, plan autumn planting

> **SUMMER PRIORITY**
> Watering and harvesting are your main jobs. Pick courgettes and beans regularly — if they get too large, the plant stops producing. Harvest little and often.

Autumn

September · October · November

SEPTEMBER

Sow outdoors: Overwintering broad beans, green manure, winter salads under cover
Plant out: Garlic (best month), spring cabbage, overwintering onion sets
Harvest: Apples, pears, squash, main crop potatoes, last tomatoes, beetroot
Key tasks: Clear spent crops, add compost to empty beds, net brassicas

OCTOBER

Plant out: More garlic, fruit trees and bushes (bare root season starts)
Harvest: Pumpkins, late squash, kale, chard, leeks, root vegetables
Key tasks: Mulch beds for winter, bring tender plants indoors, clean and store pots

NOVEMBER

Plant out: Bare root fruit trees and bushes, rhubarb crowns
Harvest: Kale, leeks, parsnips (improve after frost), winter salads
Key tasks: Dig over heavy soil, review the year, plan next season, order seed catalogues

AUTUMN PRIORITY

Autumn is for closing the current season well and setting up the next one. Garlic planted now will be ready next summer. Compost added now will feed spring crops. Every autumn task is an investment in next year.

Winter

December · January · February

DECEMBER

Harvest: Kale, leeks, parsnips, Brussels sprouts, winter salads

Key tasks: Protect overwintering crops with fleece if hard frost expected. Plan next year. Order seeds early for best selection.

JANUARY

Sow indoors: Early chillies, aubergines (very early start, warm windowsill only)

Harvest: Leeks, kale, parsnips, stored squash

Key tasks: Clean tools, repair beds and structures, chit seed potatoes from late January

FEBRUARY

Sow indoors: Tomatoes (late Feb), peppers, lettuce, broad beans (in modules)

Sow outdoors: Broad beans (direct, if mild), parsnips, early peas under cover

Key tasks: Prepare beds as soil dries, top up compost, set up seed trays and propagators

Winter planning checklist

- Review last season — what worked, what to change
- Plan crop rotation — do not grow the same thing in the same spot
- Order seeds early for best selection
- Clean and sharpen tools
- Repair or replace beds, pots, supports
- Check compost supply — order or start making
- Update your planner with next season's layout

> **WINTER PRIORITY**
>
> Winter is for resting, planning, and preparing. Resist the urge to start too early — most seeds sown before March will struggle without supplemental heat and light. Use this time to plan well so spring is productive from day one.

Year at a glance

S = Sow · P = Plant out · H = Harvest. This is a general guide for temperate climates. Adjust for your local conditions and frost dates.

CROP	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
Lettuce		S	S	S	H	H	H	S	H	H		
Tomatoes		S	S		P		H	H	H			
Courgettes				S	P	H	H	H	H			
Beans				S	P		H	H	H			
Peas		S	S	S		H	H					
Radishes			S	S	H	H	S	H	H			
Potatoes			P	P		H	H	H	H			
Carrots			S	S	S	S	H	H	H	H		
Kale			S	S	P			H	H	H	H	H
Garlic							H		P	P		
Broad beans		S	S			H	H				S	
Strawberries			P	P		H	H					
Herbs			S	S	P	H	H	H	H			

Companion planting — quick reference

Good companions

Tomatoes + basil · Carrots + onions · Beans + sweetcorn · Lettuce + radishes · Strawberries + chives · Courgettes + nasturtiums

Keep apart

Tomatoes + potatoes (blight risk) · Beans + onions · Fennel + most crops · Mint + everything (grows into it all)

Pin this calendar where you can see it. Check it at the start of each month. Knowing what to do when is the difference between a productive garden and a stressful one.

Eva — Grow Food System